Yes, of course.

I embraced her lightly, thanked her.

Outside, on the street, my head was swimming. In each direction there was an amazing collection of restaurants and shops, and I'd have given anything to walk up and down, look in the windows, give myself time to process all I'd said and learned.

But, of course, impossible.

Didn't want to cause a scene.

27.

THE THERAPIST, it so happened, had met Tiggy. Astounding coincidence. Smallest of all possible worlds. So in another session we talked about Tiggy, how she'd been a surrogate mum to me and Willy, how Willy and I had often turned women into surrogate mums. How often they'd eagerly cast themselves in that role.

Surrogate mums made me feel better, I admitted, and worse, because I felt guilty. *What would Mummy think?*

We talked about guilt.

I mentioned Mummy's experience with therapy, as I understood it. Didn't help her. Might've made things worse, actually. So many people preyed on her, exploited her—including therapists.

We talked about Mummy's parenting, how she could sometimes over-mother, then disappear for stretches. It seemed an important discussion, but also disloyal.

More guilt.

We talked about life inside the British bubble, inside the royal bubble. A bubble inside a bubble—impossible to describe to anyone who hasn't actually experienced it. People simply didn't realize: they heard the word "royal," or "prince," and lost all rationality. *Ah, a prince—you have no problems.*

They assumed…no, they'd been taught…it was all a fairytale. We weren't human.